(*Dawn*, 2009). The heavily armed militants of TTP moved from Swat to Buner. The Western media raised an alarm that Islamabad was now only 80 miles away. It created a scare, though absurdly imaginative, that the militants might ultimately capture the capital and then, maybe the nuclear weapons (*The Nation*, 2009). Once again the situation had worsened enough to be resolved through military might. It generated mass public support for the military operation. Thus, the army moved ahead to launch Operation 'Rah-e-Rast' that paid dividends.

This agreement that followed failed too, resulting in a renewed cycle of violence that saw Fazlullah and his militants taking over Mingora in May 2009. Emboldened by their victories, the militants entered contiguous Buner and Shangla districts, only 60 miles away from Islamabad (Constable, 2009). This led the government to launch a decisive military operation to contain the threat. Within two months of Operation 'Rah-e-Rast', Fazlullah escaped to Afghanistan and many of his militants were either killed or arrested (Khattak, 2012).

The government carried out a couple of covert and tacit deals/understandings with different militant groups to stop them from targeting Pakistani security forces or targets inside Pakistan. One such deal was concluded with Hafiz Gul Bahadur and his militants. In exchange for not targeting Pakistani interests, the security forces would not target him and his militants in North Waziristan. A similar non-aggression pact was reached with Faqir Muhammad in Bajaur after the conclusion of the military operation 'Sherdil' in 2008. After the conclusion of military operation Sirat-i-Mustaqeem in June 2008, authorities made an unwritten agreement with Lashkar-e-Islam militants in Khyber Agency, which was breached later (Khattak, 2012).

All the peace deals were usually negotiated after the military operations failed to get the desired results in a classic battle pitched between guerrilla force and a conventional army. After reviewing the entire peace deals, we can conclude that the peace agreements gave sizeable concessions to the opponents and were not negotiated from the position of strength. None of the deals exacted any conditions for the Taliban like surrendering weapons, or disbanding foreign militants. The authorities gave a huge amount of money as compensation for damages incurred during military operations that were siphoned off to fuel and fund Taliban-led militancy. All the peace deals were struck after the conclusion of a major military operation that failed to achieve its aims.